

ENG 1005 · Grammar & Mechanics Practice Questions

Writing About Mystery and Thriller

Use these 20 practice questions to get ready for the exam. They cover the same skills but use different sentences. Circle the letter of the best answer, then check the separate **Answer Key** to see how you did and why.

Clauses (Independent vs. Subordinate)

1. While the storm raged outside

- A. Independent clause (IC)
- B. Subordinate clause (SC)

2. The inspector dusted the doorknob for prints

- A. Independent clause (IC)
- B. Subordinate clause (SC)

Sentence Fragments

3. Creeping silently toward the cellar door.

- A. Complete sentence; no change needed.
- B. Fragment → The thief was creeping silently toward the cellar door.
- C. Fragment → Creeping silently. Toward the cellar door.
- D. Fragment → Creeping silently toward the cellar door, slowly.

4. The coroner examined the body twice.

- A. Complete sentence; no change needed.
- B. Fragment → Because the coroner examined the body twice.
- C. Fragment → The coroner examining the body twice.
- D. Fragment → Examined the body twice.

Comma Splices & Run-ons

5. The phone rang twice, then it went dead.

- A. Comma splice → The phone rang twice; then it went dead.
- B. Correct as written.
- C. Fragment → The phone rang twice. Then.

6. Footsteps echoed in the hall someone was awake.

- A. Fused sentence → Footsteps echoed in the hall; someone was awake.
- B. Comma splice → Footsteps echoed in the hall someone, was awake.
- C. Correct as written.

Commas

7. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A. Before dawn, the detectives searched the garden.
- B. Before dawn the detectives, searched the garden.
- C. Before, dawn the detectives searched the garden.

8. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A. The clue, a single feather pointed to the aviary.
- B. The clue, a single feather, pointed to the aviary.
- C. The clue a single feather, pointed to the aviary.

Semicolons & Colons

9. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A. The motive was clear: revenge.
- B. The motive was clear; revenge.
- C. The motive was clear revenge.

10. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

- A. The storm cut the phone lines, the guests were trapped.
- B. The storm cut the phone lines; the guests were trapped.
- C. The storm cut the phone lines the guests were trapped.

Coordination & Subordination

11. Combine: "The safe was empty. The thief had been there first."

- A. The safe was empty because the thief had been there first.
- B. The safe was empty, the thief had been there first.
- C. The safe was empty the thief had been there first.

12. Combine: "She knew the truth. She said nothing."

- A. Although she knew the truth, she said nothing.
- B. She knew the truth she said nothing.
- C. She knew the truth, she said nothing.

Parallelism

13. Which sentence is parallel?

- A. The suspect was nervous, evasive, and lied often.
- B. The suspect was nervous, evasive, and dishonest.
- C. The suspect was nervous, evasive, and a liar too.

14. Which sentence is parallel?

- A. The detective enjoyed reading files, to interview witnesses, and stakeouts.
- B. The detective enjoyed reading files, interviewing witnesses, and running stakeouts.
- C. The detective enjoyed to read files, interviewing witnesses, and stakeouts.

Misplaced & Dangling Modifiers

15. Which sentence is clear and correct?

- A. Locked from the inside, the detective studied the door.
- B. The detective studied the door, which was locked from the inside.
- C. The detective studied, locked from the inside, the door.

16. Which sentence is clear and correct?

- A. She nearly questioned all of the guests.
- B. She questioned nearly all of the guests.
- C. She questioned all of the guests nearly.

Agreement & Pronoun Case

17. Neither the witness nor the suspects _____ telling the truth.

- A. was
- B. were

18. The committee announced _____ decision.

- A. its
- B. their

19. The reward was split between her and _____.

- A. I
- B. me

20. Each of the clues _____ a story.

- A. tells
- B. tell